

Everyone Else • 37/39 • Ali ibn Muhammad al-Samarri

The Last Letter. Ali was the fourth of the four, and the last letter he ever received said there would not be a fifth. Five items, no event print, dateless.

One style for the whole line — Fraunces and Nunito Sans, cut paper, the person on a stamp. Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

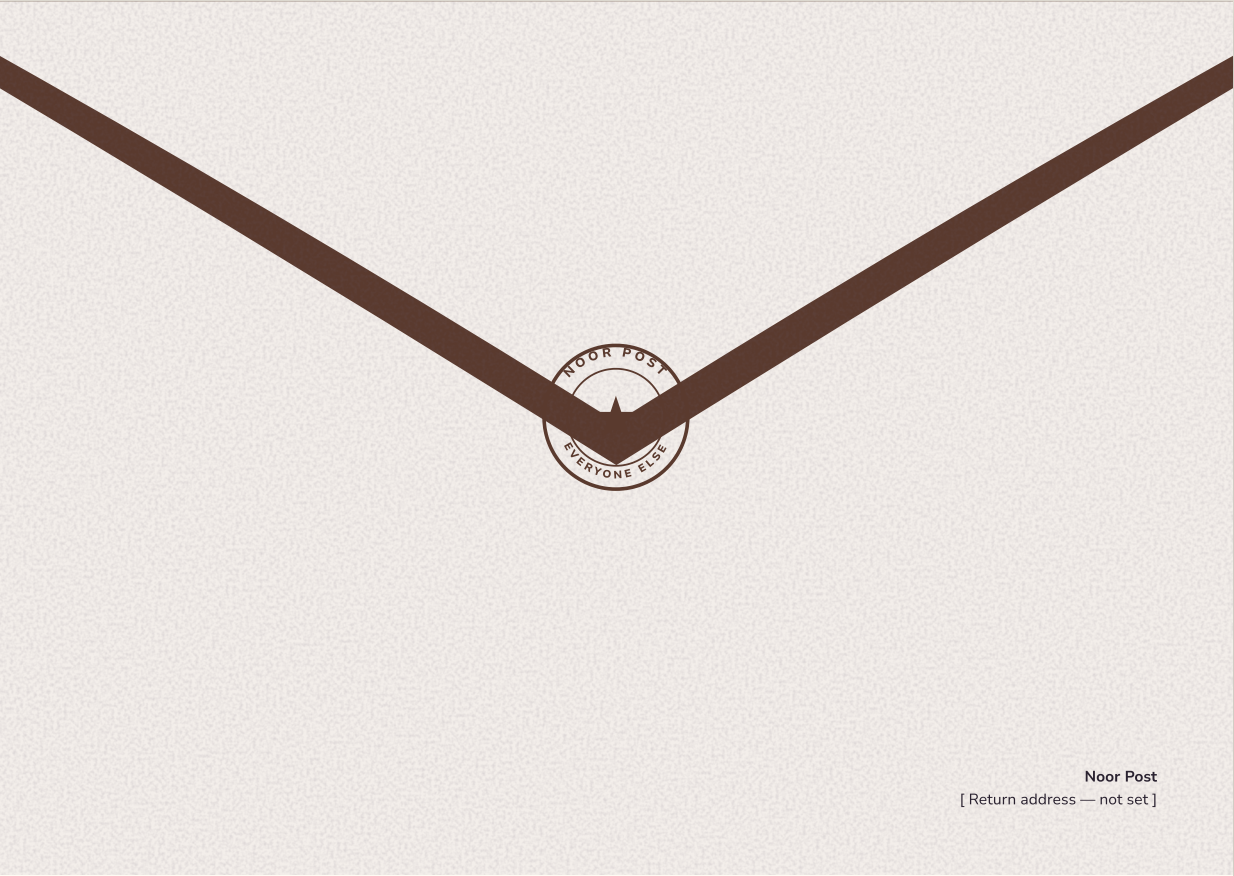
NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

**Ali was the fourth of the four,
and the last letter he ever
received said there would not
be a fifth.**

FOR

[Child's name]





INSIDE THE FLAP

EVERYONE ELSE · ALI IBN
MUHAMMAD AL-SAMARRI
· INSIDE THE FLAP

Open together.

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

1 · THE LETTER — ONE A4 SHEET FOLDED TO A5

Ali ibn Muhammad al-Samarri

- **Who he served.** Fourth and final of the trusted agents (*sufara'*) of Imam al-Mahdi, named by Husayn ibn Ruh before his death.
- **How long he held it.** The shortest of the four terms — only a few years, by most accounts, before his own death closed the arrangement.
- **What he received.** A final letter (*tawqi'*), close to his own death, instructing him not to name a successor and instructing the community not to accept anyone who claimed the post afterward.
- **What that meant.** The end of an arrangement that had run, one man to the next, for about seventy years — ended in writing, on purpose, not left to trail off unexplained.
- **Why he is in this envelope.** *Ali was the fourth of the four, and the last letter he ever received said there would not be a fifth.*

He died shortly after, and no fifth deputy was ever named.

UNVERIFIED — NO VERIFY

The Last Letter



● is the grown-up · ○ is you · ●○ is together

- Ali ibn Muhammad al-Samarri was the fourth man to hold the post. By the time it came to him it was an old arrangement with a well-worn shape to it.

○ What shape?

- A man holds it. He grows old. Before he dies he names the next one. That had happened three times, over about seventy years, and it had never once failed.

○ So everyone expected a fifth?

- Everyone. There was no reason on earth to think otherwise.

○ What happened?

- A letter came for him, near the end of his life, carried the same careful way as every letter before it. It said he would die soon. It said he should put his affairs in order. And it said there would be no next man.

○ None at all?

THE LAST LETTER · CONTINUED

- None. It told him to name nobody, and it told everyone else not to believe anyone who claimed the job after him. Seventy years of arrangement, closed on purpose, in writing.

- **What did he do with it?**

- Exactly what he had done with every other letter. He passed it on. He did not soften it for the people who wanted it softened, and he did not add a word of his own to the end of it.

- **Did people accept it?**

- Not all of them, and not straight away. Men did stand up afterwards claiming the job, exactly as the letter had warned, and each time the community had the letter to hold up against them. That is what it was for.

- **So the letter was the point?**

- The letter was the last thing the arrangement ever did, and it was built to keep working after everyone in it was dead. Seventy years of handing things carefully from one man to the next, and the final handover was to nobody.

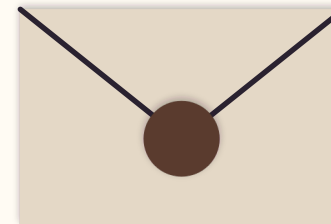
- **Could you carry news like that? Say why or why not.**

- It is the hardest thing on this list. Everything else the four did was carrying. This was carrying the news that the carrying was over.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦

**Three men before him
named a fourth. He
named nobody.**



Then the hadith card.

FIRST EDITION · 37/39

NO SAYING SELECTED

Blocked on a source — nothing prints here until
its row on citation-sheet.md reads V

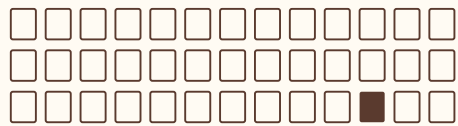


NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT · THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

The other chain

The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected
in any order.



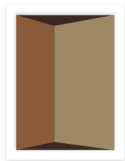
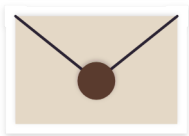
First edition · thirty-nine cards

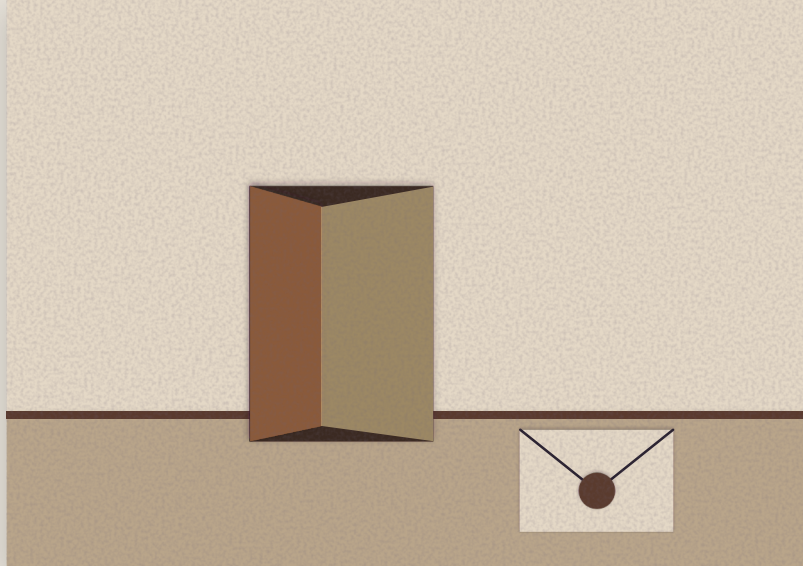
Blocked: Same as 35 — Kitab al-Ghayba held, no conduct-register
tawqi' found.

Back — its own chain, no silsila number



Ali ibn Muhammad al-Samarri





**We opened this one
together.**

• _____

○ _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]
